AMMU SWAMINATHAN

1894–1978



“EQUAL RIGHTS IS A GREAT THING AND IT IS ONLY FITTING THAT IT HAS BEEN INCLUDED IN THE CONSTITUTION…”

The right to learn

Ammu Swaminathan was from Palakkad, in present-day Kerala. At the age of thirteen, she was married to a friend of her father’s, Dr Subbarama Swaminathan, who was twenty years her senior. Young Ammu is believed to have only agreed to the marriage on the condition that she would be allowed to pursue an education after. Most girls who were married off young never had this chance, but Ammu was determined to make something of her life. In later years, she strongly advocated for a law against child marriage.